

PIYUSH SONTAKKE

Full-Stack Engineer | Python · Django · React/Next.js · Agentic AI / LLM Applications

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Open to relocation (Bengaluru / Mumbai / NCR) and remote · UTC+5:30, comfortable overlap with UK/EU hours

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-Stack Engineer with 2+ years of production experience building Python/Django and React/Next.js web applications end-to-end as an independent contractor for startups, and since 2026 as founder of a solo AI product studio. Owns systems from PostgreSQL schema design and REST APIs through frontend and AWS deployment. Specialised in integration-heavy backends (payment gateways, webhooks, reconciliation) and LLM/agentic AI features: OpenAI API, LangChain, RAG pipelines and multi-agent workflows. Ships fast, tests with pytest, and keeps production stable.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript (ES6+), SQL, HTML/CSS

Backend & APIs: Django, Django REST Framework (DRF), FastAPI, RESTful API design, Webhook architecture, JWT authentication, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Pydantic

Frontend: React, Next.js (SSR/SSG), Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, responsive UI, REST API integration

Data & Async: PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, Django ORM (query optimization, complex joins, pagination), background jobs, cron scheduling, data reconciliation

AI / LLM: OpenAI API, LangChain, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), vector databases, multi-agent systems, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, LLM evaluation (evals), observability/tracing, guardrails, structured outputs

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2), Docker, Docker Compose, Nginx, Linux, production deployment, monitoring & incident debugging, Git/GitHub

Payments & Integrations: SabPaisa, PhonePe, Pine Labs payment gateways, AES encryption, WhatsApp Business API, third-party API integration

Testing & Tools: pytest (unit & integration tests), webhook simulation, Postman

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Engagement type: all roles below were independent contract / freelance engagements (invoice-based) or self-employment, not full-time employment. Work samples and references available on request.

Founder & Product Engineer - ElixirFlow (self-employed) | Apr 2026 - Present | Remote

- Founded a solo AI product-engineering studio; sole engineer shipping production tools end-to-end: design, Django/React build, AWS deployment and client delivery.
- DocChase - WhatsApp-first document-collection tool for CA firms: automated request/track/escalate workflows against GST/ITR filing deadlines (Django, Celery, Redis, PostgreSQL, WhatsApp Business API).
- AgentAudit - production-readiness audit kit for LLM/agent systems: authored a 30-point checklist covering evals, tracing/observability, guardrails, cost controls and fallback paths; productized it with a landing page and paid audits.
- Designed and shipped marketing, demo and client business websites with Next.js/React; owned UX, build, deployment (Nginx/AWS) and iteration from user feedback.

Independent Full-Stack Engineer - Freelance / Contract | May 2024 - Apr 2026 | Remote & Pune

Delivered backend and full-stack engineering for startup clients on a contract basis, from scoping and estimation through build, deployment and production support. Key client engagements:

Corporate Gifting & E-commerce Startup (client name withheld) - Lead Product Engineer (contract) |

Nov 2025 - Apr 2026 | Remote

- Integrated third-party payment gateways (SabPaisha, Pinelabs) with custom AES encryption, webhook-based callbacks and automated reconciliation workflows.
- Built asynchronous task pipelines with Celery and Redis for order processing, real-time balance updates and background sync with external API providers.
- Designed scalable Django + PostgreSQL services handling large datasets with optimized ORM queries, joins and pagination.
- Implemented webhook receivers for payment and logistics providers with retries and error handling for reliable event processing.
- Owned the full backend lifecycle as the sole backend engineer: schema design, API development, Docker/Nginx deployment on AWS EC2 and production stability monitoring.

Payments & Commerce Startup, Pune (client name withheld) - Backend Engineer, Python/Django (contract) | May 2024 - Nov 2025 | Pune

- Developed Python-based integration workflows connecting SabPaisha, PhonePe and Pinelabs APIs, achieving 100% reconciliation accuracy against third-party API documentation.
- Built webhook handlers and callback processing for payment status updates, handling rate limits, retries and edge cases in external API responses.
- Refactored legacy APIs with Django REST Framework, improving data consistency by 50% and response time by 15%.
- Built backend automation for order, transaction and operational workflows with async job scheduling; debugged production issues to improve uptime under peak traffic.

PROJECTS

Gyfton - Product Gifting Platform | Python, DRF, PostgreSQL, Celery, Redis, Docker, AWS

- Architected backend APIs for products, orders, categories, and user management with clean service separation and REST best practices.
- Implemented secure JWT authentication and role-based access control (RBAC); built webhook-driven integrations for catalogue and logistics providers.
- Implemented Celery/Redis background processing for order lifecycle, audit logging, and moderation; wrote pytest suites covering endpoints, webhook simulations, and edge cases.
- Deployed on AWS EC2 with Docker Compose and Nginx, optimized for high concurrency.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

Bachelor of Technology, Electronics & Communication Engineering - Rajiv Gandhi College of Engineering, Chandrapur (2023)

PG Certification, Generative AI & Multi-Agent Systems - Coding Ninjas × IIT Mandi-TIH